

The Scientific Revolution

In the 16th and 17th centuries, groundbreaking scientific discoveries and developments revolutionized our understanding of the world. The Scientific Revolution got underway when European thinkers—mostly men as women were barred from studying—began to challenge the opinions of ancient philosophers and the accepted beliefs of Christianity. This gave rise to a new “scientific method,” based on the principle that ideas need to be tested with experiments to see if they are true.

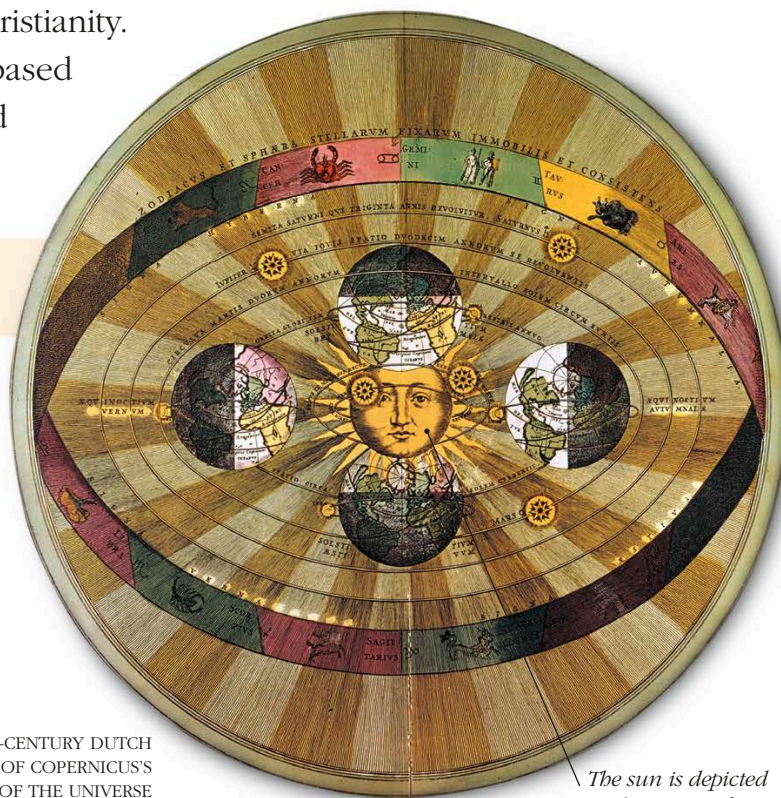
Copernican revolution

Nicolaus Copernicus

Where Poland

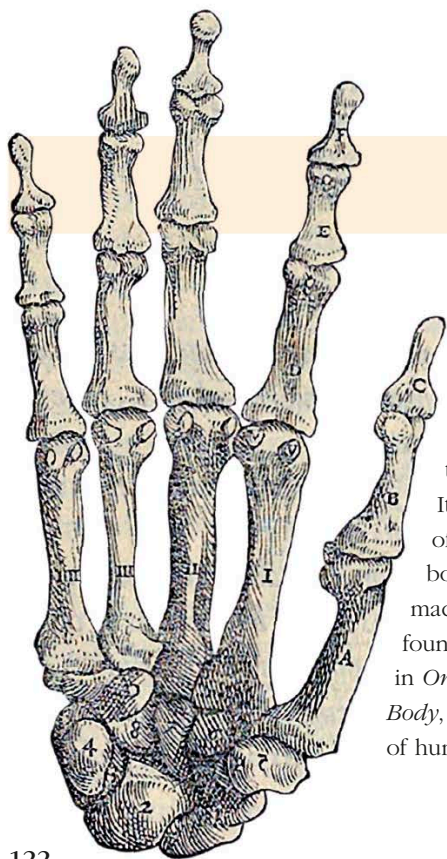
When 1543

Our understanding of the universe was transformed by Polish astronomer Nicolaus Copernicus, who argued that the planets rotated around the sun. His revolutionary ideas were published in the book *On the Revolutions of the Celestial Spheres*, which sparked a lot of controversy because they challenged the belief supported by the Christian Church that Earth was the centre of the universe.



17TH-CENTURY DUTCH
ENGRAVING OF COPERNICUS'S
MODEL OF THE UNIVERSE

The sun is depicted
as the center of
the universe.



Human anatomy

Andreas Vesalius

Where Switzerland

When 1543

Physician Andreas Vesalius thought that the only way to understand the human body was to see inside it. While studying in Italy and Switzerland, he spent a lot of time dissecting (cutting up) the bodies of executed criminals and made accurate drawings of what he found. His illustrations were published in *On the Structure of the Human Body*, which revolutionized the study of human anatomy.

Compound microscope

Hans and Zacharias Janssen

Where Netherlands

When early 1590s

Dutch father and son Hans and Zacharias Janssen found that looking through lenses placed at both ends of a tube made objects appear bigger. Although the magnification of their pioneering compound microscope (a microscope with more than one lens) was limited, it was the first step in opening up the invisible world of microorganisms.

